

Xbox Pricing Announced

Microsoft will be selling the Xbox 360 at \$299 (Rs 13,000). A more expensive version costing \$399 (Rs 17,400) will include a 20 GB hard drive, wireless controller, headset and remote control. Microsoft is aiming to get the console onto shelves in time for Christmas this year.



Pre-Paid Phone Tabs

The Malaysian government will stop the anonymous use of mobiles—people using prepaid services will have to register their details with phone companies. The decision follows worries about the use of unregistered phones by members of violent militant groups, either to communicate or to trigger explosions.



Enter

Pooja Bedi

Actress and model

Pooja Bedi is India's original glam girl and is today a name that commands respect in the glam industry. As a model, actress, TV host, author, candid columnist and a doting mom, Bedi is a trendsetter. Here's her take on technology.

What does technology mean to you?

Technology helps me enhance my life in more ways than you can imagine. It's a necessity when it comes to work, entertainment, recreation and even on the household front.

How do you use technology in your day-to-day life?

I am very computer-savvy. At home, I make extensive use of the Internet. I love music and I burn and compile my own music collection. I like the facility of online photo albums as well—and I even take prints as and when needed!

What gadgets do you own?

I have a smartphone on which I can record one hour of video. My mobile helps me remain accessible at all times—I realise its importance even more when I am overseas. I also use a digital camcorder. I love shopping for gadgets.

Has technology influenced your career?

Technology has increased my productivity manifold. For instance, when I'm researching a topic or person for my TV show, I get lots of data online. I consider Google a good friend! Essentially, technology is a requisite and I advocate using it to the fullest to make life easier and more exciting.

FOES IN WAITING

Hackers And Virus Writers Eye Vista

Although there's still more than a year before Microsoft's new Vista OS hits the shelves, work is on in full swing to bring it down! Virus writers are already working on ways of hacking Vista.

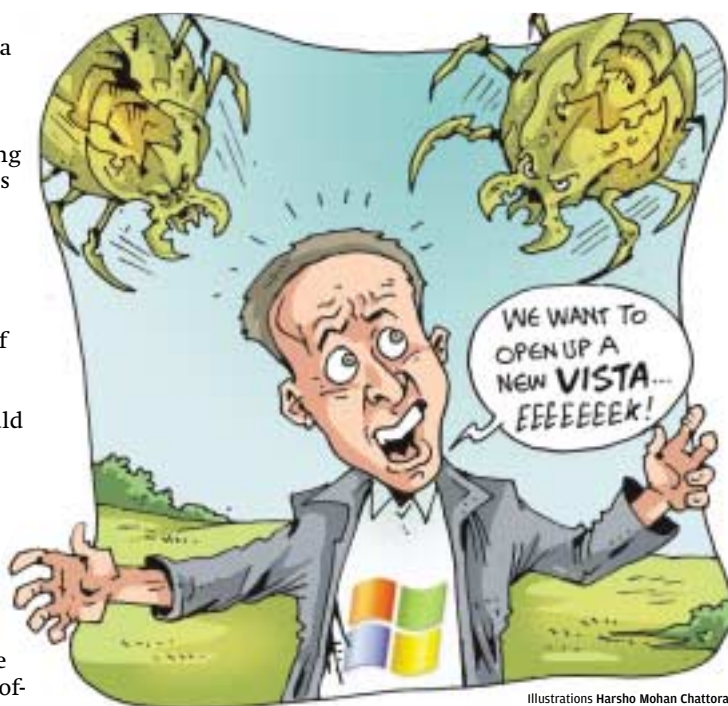
An Austrian programmer has published examples of malicious code that exploits loopholes in technology which could be part of Vista. The viruses affect Microsoft's command shell technology, which is expected to replace the current command prompt. Security company F-Secure described the malicious code as proof-of-concept viruses to highlight potential vulnerabilities in Vista.

Security experts had, in 2004, sounded warning bells about a possible attack on the command shell. But Microsoft has announced that the new technology will not ship with the final version of Vista.

Windows runs on almost 90 per cent of PCs worldwide. In view of this, the security risks that an exploit might pose are heightened.

According to Microsoft, security would not be an add-on but an integral part of the operating system.

As it stands, though, one



Illustrations Harsho Mohan Chatteraj

has to wonder whether things would be any different with Vista if MS cannot plug information holes within its organisation to start with.

For a sneak peek at Vista, turn to 'New and Notable' in this issue

THEY'VE JOINED THE BANDWAGON

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They already sell books, clothes, computers and

peripherals, sporting goods, electronics, shoes and what not! But online retail major Amazon.com is preparing to offer a digital-music service. According to *The Wall Street Journal* executives, the online retailer recently held talks with record-label executives. The licensing options discussed included song-by-song downloads and a monthly subscription service similar to the iTunes music download packages.

The paper also reported that Amazon has discussed tapping MusicNet, a New York distributor of digital music, to support the service. The online retailer